DentVault

Practitioner Handbook

A complete guide to managing patients, clinical timelines, treatment plans, dental charting, periodontal probing, and practice analytics.

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CHAPTER 1 Introduction

DentVault is a cross-platform desktop application for independent dental practitioners and small clinics. All data is stored locally on your device in a secure vault folder you control — no cloud, no subscriptions, no third-party servers.

What DentVault Does

- **Patient management** — demographics, medical history, status tracking
- **Clinical timeline** — chronological treatment history with structured categories and outcomes
- **Treatment plans** — multi-step plans with cost tracking and completion progress
- **Dental chart** — visual SVG tooth chart with per-surface tagging, bridges, prosthetics
- **Periodontal probing** — full 6-point probing with recession, CAL, BOP, mobility, furcation
- **Documents** — file attachments organised by configurable categories
- **Analytics** — practice-level outcome statistics, provider performance, trend reports

Clinical Intelligence Philosophy

DentVault is not just a record system — it is a **clinical outcome engine**. Every treatment entry is tagged with a structured category and outcome so you can ask questions like:

- "*Of all root canals performed in the last 3 years, what percentage were retreated?*"
- "*Show all Class II patients — what was the post-treatment occlusal result?*"
- "*Which provider has the highest extraction rate after crown placement?*"

This is only possible because every piece of clinical data is **structured and queryable** — never buried in free-text notes.

Data Ownership

> **YOUR DATA, YOUR VAULT**
> All records are stored in a single folder on your computer called the *vault*. You can back it up, move it to an external drive, or archive it. DentVault never transmits your patient data anywhere.

CHAPTER 2 Getting Started

First Launch — Vault Setup

The first time you open DentVault, you will be prompted to choose a vault location. This is the folder where all patient data, documents, and the audit log will be stored.

1. Click **Choose Vault Folder** in the welcome screen.
2. Navigate to a folder on your computer (e.g. `Documents/DentVault`).
3. Click **Select**. DentVault initialises the database inside that folder.
4. The main interface loads. You are ready to add your first patient.

📸 `screenshots/vault-setup.png Welcome screen with vault folder picker`

First-launch vault configuration screen

> **BACKUP RECOMMENDATION**
> Store your vault on a folder that is synced by iCloud, Dropbox, or a similar service — or schedule regular manual backups. DentVault does not backup automatically.

Interface Overview

The app has a persistent left sidebar with navigation to all major sections.

📸 `screenshots/sidebar.png Left sidebar with Patients, Dashboard, Reports, Settings`

Left sidebar — Patients, Dashboard, Reports, and Settings

Section	Purpose
Patients	List of all patients — search, filter by status, open profiles
Dashboard	Practice-wide outcome statistics and analytics
Reports	Filterable entry table with CSV export
Settings	Customise categories, tags, staff, shortcuts, and more

CHAPTER 3 Managing Patients

The Patient List

The Patients page is your main directory. It shows all patients with their status, last visit date, and a quick search bar.

📸 `screenshots/patients-list.png Patient list with search bar, status badges, and patient cards`

Patient list with search, status filter, and patient cards

Patient Statuses

Status	Meaning
Active	Currently receiving treatment or on recall
Inactive	Not seen recently; may need recall contact
Archived	No longer a patient; record retained for history
Deceased	Deceased patient; record locked

Creating a New Patient

1. Click the **New Patient** button (top-right of the Patients page).
2. Enter the patient's **first and last name** (required).
3. Fill in demographics: date of birth, gender, contact details, address.
4. Add medical history flags, allergies, and any relevant conditions.
5. Click **Save Patient** . The patient profile opens immediately.

📸 `screenshots/new-patient-form.png New patient form with name, DOB, contact fields`

New patient form — required fields are marked with an asterisk

Patient Profile Overview

Each patient profile is divided into tabs accessible from the toolbar at the top of the patient page:

Tab / Section	Contents
Timeline	Chronological clinical entries, inline images, document links
Treatment Plans	Multi-step planned procedures with cost and status

Dental Chart	Visual tooth chart — conditions, surfaces, bridges
Perio	Periodontal probing records over time
Documents	Attached files, X-rays, referral letters, photos

QUICK SEARCH TIP

The patient search bar matches on name, ID, and phone number. Press `/` anywhere in the app to focus the search bar instantly.

CHAPTER 4 Clinical Timeline

The timeline is the heart of a patient's record — a chronological log of every clinical encounter, observation, and treatment. Each entry is a structured record, not just a free-text note.

📸 `screenshots/timeline-overview.png Patient timeline showing multiple entries with category badges`

Patient timeline — entries displayed newest first with category and outcome badges

Adding a New Entry

1. Click the **+ Add Entry** button in the timeline toolbar.
2. Type your clinical note in the text field. As you type, the smart tag suggestion bar appears below if it detects clinical keywords.
3. Select a **treatment category** from the dropdown (or accept the suggestion).
4. Optionally set a **treatment outcome** and **tooth numbers** .
5. Tag the **primary doctor** and any colleagues involved.
6. Click **Save** or press `Ctrl` + `Enter` .

📸 `screenshots/add-entry.png Add entry form with text field, category dropdown, and tag suggestion bar`

New entry form — note the smart tag suggestion bar below the text field

Treatment Categories

Every entry must be tagged with one of the following categories. These are used for analytics and outcome tracking.

Category	Typical Procedures
Endodontics	Root canal, retreatment, apicoectomy, pulpotomy, pulp cap
Orthodontics	Fixed appliances, aligners, retainers, space maintainers
Prosthodontics	Crowns, bridges, dentures, veneers, implant prosthetics
Periodontics	Scaling, root planing, flap surgery, implant placement
Oral Surgery	Extractions, biopsies, frenectomy, impacted third molars
Restorative	Composite, amalgam fillings, inlays, onlays
Preventive	Cleaning, sealants, fluoride, check-ups

Imaging	Periapical, panoramic, CBCT, cephalometric

Treatment Outcomes

Recording outcomes is what makes DentVault's analytics meaningful. Set the outcome when treatment is complete or at follow-up:

Outcome	When to use
Successful	Treatment achieved its goal; tooth/area is stable
Ongoing	Treatment in progress or too early to evaluate
Retreated	Same procedure had to be repeated on the same tooth
Failed → Extracted	Treatment failed; tooth was subsequently extracted
Failed → Other	Treatment failed; alternative treatment was performed

Smart Tag Suggestions

As you type a clinical note, DentVault scans for keywords and surfaces non-intrusive tag chips below the text field. You can **Accept** or **Dismiss** each suggestion — tags are never applied automatically.

📸 `screenshots/tag-suggestions.png Tag suggestion bar with chips for 'Endodontics' and tooth number`

Smart tag suggestion bar — click a chip to accept; click × to dismiss

If you type…	Suggested tag
`root canal`, `RCT`, `endodontic`	Category: Endodontics
`crown`, `bridge`, `veneer`	Category: Prosthodontics
`extraction`, `surgical extract`	Category: Oral Surgery
`retreatment`, `re-treatment`	Outcome: Retreated + Related Entry chip
`extracted due to`	Outcome: Failed → Extracted + Related Entry chip
`tooth 14`, `#14`, `FDI 24`	Tooth number tag

> **NEGATION DETECTION**
> Phrases like "*no signs of caries*" or "*ruled out periodontitis*" suppress the corresponding suggestion — DentVault will not suggest a Periodontics tag if the note says there is no periodontal involvement.

Doctor & Colleague Tagging

Each entry can be attributed to a primary doctor (selected from a dropdown) and one or more colleagues (using the `@` mention palette in the text field).

1. In the entry text field, type `@` followed by the first letters of a staff member's name.
2. A palette appears — click the name or press `Enter` to insert the mention.
3. The mentioned colleague is tagged on the entry and appears in doctor attribution reports.

Text Block Shortcuts

Pre-defined text blocks can be inserted into any entry using the `/` command palette. For example, typing `/postop` might expand to your standard post-operative instructions. Manage text blocks in **Settings** → **Text Blocks**.

Attachments on Entries

Drag an image file onto an entry or use the attachment button to add X-rays, intraoral photos, or scanned documents directly to a timeline entry. Images display as inline thumbnails that can be expanded with a click.

📸 `screenshots/entry-with-image.png Timeline entry showing an expanded intraoral photograph`

Timeline entry with an attached image expanded inline

CHAPTER 5 Treatment Plans

Treatment plans allow you to outline a proposed sequence of procedures for a patient, track completion, and record estimated costs. A plan is separate from the timeline — it represents *planned* work, while timeline entries record what has *actually been done*.

📸 `screenshots/treatment-plans.png Treatment plan list showing plan name, progress bar, and cost total`

Treatment plan list — each plan shows its items, completion status, and total cost

Creating a Treatment Plan

1. In the patient profile, open the **Treatment Plans** section.
2. Click **New Plan** and give it a descriptive name (e.g. "*Full mouth rehabilitation Q2 2026*").
3. Add plan items — each item has a description, tooth number(s), estimated cost, and ordering.
4. Save the plan. Items are listed in sequence with checkboxes.

Completing Plan Items

When a procedure from the plan is carried out, mark the plan item as complete by clicking its checkbox. You can optionally link it to the corresponding timeline entry — this creates a permanent connection between the planned procedure and the clinical record of its execution.

📸 `screenshots/plan-items.png Plan items list with checkboxes, tooth numbers, and cost column`

Plan items — check off each item as it is completed; link to a timeline entry for traceability

Plan Statuses

Status	Meaning
Draft	Plan created, not yet presented to patient
Active	Plan accepted; treatment in progress
Completed	All items marked complete
Cancelled	Plan abandoned; retained for history

COST TRACKING

The plan automatically totals item costs and shows how much has been "completed" vs. still outstanding. This is for reference only — DentVault does not issue invoices.

CHAPTER 6 Dental Chart

The dental chart is a fully interactive SVG diagram of all 32 teeth. Click any tooth to view and edit its condition, surface tags, notes, and history. The chart uses **FDI notation** throughout.

📸 `screenshots/dental-chart-overview.png Full dental chart with two-column layout — SVG on left, detail panel on right`

Dental chart — SVG chart on the left, tooth detail panel on the right

Reading the Chart

Each tooth is drawn with a crown (divided into 5 surfaces) and roots. The fill colour of each surface reflects the assigned clinical tag:

Condition / Tag	Visual appearance
Healthy	White crown, no fill
Caries	Surface filled with the caries colour (default: dark amber)
Filling	Surface filled with the filling colour (default: blue)
Crown	Full crown fill, outlined border
Root Canal	Light purple crown + purple obturated canal line in roots
Implant	Gray fixture rectangle with thread lines; no roots drawn
Extracted	Diagonal X across the tooth outline
Missing	Dashed tooth outline

Selecting and Editing a Tooth

1. Click any tooth in the SVG chart. It highlights in blue and the detail panel opens on the right.
2. In the detail panel, click the **overall condition** button that matches the tooth's status.
3. To tag individual surfaces, click a surface cell in the 3×3 grid (Buccal, Occlusal, Lingual, Mesial, Distal). Multiple surfaces can be selected by dragging.
4. With surfaces selected, click a tag button to apply that tag to all selected surfaces.
5. Add freeform **notes** and a **last examined date**. These auto-save after a short pause.

📸 `screenshots/tooth-detail-panel.png Right-side tooth detail panel showing surface grid, condition buttons, notes`

Tooth detail panel — surface grid (top), condition buttons, notes, and condition history

Charting Mode

Charting mode guides you tooth by tooth in FDI order (18 → 11 → 21 → 28 → 38 → 31 → 41 → 48), so you can chart the whole mouth without using a mouse.

1. Click **Charting starten** in the chart toolbar. The progress bar appears.
2. The first tooth (FDI 18) is highlighted in amber on the chart. Its detail panel opens automatically.
3. Press a **letter shortcut** (e.g. `k` for Karies, `f` for Füllung) to apply a condition.
4. Press `Enter` to advance to the next tooth, or `Shift` + `Enter` to go back.
5. Click **Fertig** or press `Escape` to end charting at any time.

📸 `screenshots/charting-mode.png Dental chart in charting mode with amber highlighted tooth and progress bar`

Charting mode — progress bar at top, current tooth highlighted in amber

Default Keyboard Shortcuts

Key	Condition	Key	Condition
`g`	Gesund (Healthy)	`o`	Krone (Crown)
`k`	Karies (Caries)	`w`	Wurzelbehandlung (Root Canal)
`f`	Füllung (Filling)	`i`	Implantat (Implant)
`x`	Fehlend (Missing)	`b`	Brücke (Bridge)
`e`	Extrahiert (Extracted)	`r`	Fraktur (Fracture)

All shortcuts are user-configurable in **Settings** → **Edit Tags**.

Bridges & Prosthetics

To record a bridge, drag across the abutment and pontic teeth on the SVG chart:

1. Hold and drag from the first abutment to the last abutment tooth in the chart.
2. The Restoration Editor panel opens. Toggle each tooth between **Abutment** and **Pontic** (middle teeth default to Pontic).
3. For implant-supported bridges, click the abutment tooth and toggle **Implant abutment**.
4. Click **Confirm**. The bridge bar appears on the chart connecting the selected teeth.

To dissolve a bridge, select any tooth in the group and click **Brücke auflösen** in the detail panel.

Chart Snapshots

Click the **Snapshot** button in the chart toolbar to record the current state of all teeth against a timeline entry. Snapshots are viewable from the timeline and allow you to see how the dentition changed over time.

CHAPTER 7 Periodontal Probing

The periodontal probing chart records a full 6-point examination for all 32 teeth. Each exam session is stored as a separate record, allowing you to track pocket depth changes over time.

Open the probing chart by clicking **Perio** in the patient timeline toolbar.

📸 `screenshots/perio-overview.png Full perio chart — SVG bar graph on left, data entry panel on right`

Periodontal probing chart — bar graph visualization on the left, single-tooth data entry on the right

Reading the Probing Chart

The SVG chart displays all 32 teeth with vertical bars representing pocket depths. The upper arch (buccal above, lingual below) is separated from the lower arch by a horizontal line.

Bar colour	Pocket depth	Clinical significance
Green	1–3 mm	Within normal limits
Amber	4–5 mm	Increased probing depth; monitor
Red	≥ 6 mm	Deep pocket; active periodontitis likely

Each bar can carry additional markers:

- **Red dot** at bar tip — Bleeding on probing (BOP) is positive
- **Yellow dot** at bar base — Plaque present at that site
- **Purple segment** below the bar — Recession depth (the bar + purple segment = CAL)

The Data Entry Panel

Click any tooth on the SVG chart to open its data entry panel on the right. The panel shows one tooth at a time with all six sites arranged in two groups:

📸 `screenshots/perio-entry-panel.png Data entry panel for FDI 16 showing buccal/lingual rows with PD, recession, BOP, plaque inputs`

Single-tooth data entry panel — Buccal (top) and Lingual (bottom) with PD, Recession, BOP, and Plaque per site

Row	Input type	Description
PD	Number (0–15 mm)	Pocket depth at each site
Rec	Number (0–15 mm)	Recession depth (leave blank if not measuring)
CAL	Computed	Clinical Attachment Level = PD + Recession (auto-calculated)

BOP	Toggle circle	Red = bleeding on probing at that site
Plq	Toggle circle	Yellow = plaque visible at that site

Mobility & Furcation

Below the site measurements, the panel shows additional tooth-level findings:

Field	Values	Notes
Mobility	0, I, II, III	Shown for all teeth
Furcation	0, I, II, III	Shown only for multi-rooted teeth (molars, upper premolars)
Furcation sites	B / ML / DL (upper); B / L (lower)	Appears when furcation grade > 0

Guided Charting Mode

For full-mouth recordings, use guided charting mode to move systematically through all 32 teeth without touching the mouse.

1. Click ▶ **Start Charting** in the toolbar. The progress bar shows *0/32* .
2. The first tooth (FDI 18) is highlighted in amber on the chart and its panel opens.
3. Enter PD values by **tabbing** through the six site inputs (MB → B → DB → ML → L → DL).
4. After the last input (DL), press `Enter` to advance to the next tooth automatically.
5. Use `Shift` + `Enter` to go back to the previous tooth.
6. Press `Escape` or click ✓ **Fertig** to exit charting at any time.

> **ASSISTANT-AIDED CHARTING**
> With guided charting mode, a dental assistant can call out values while the operator enters them — the flow matches the clinical sequence exactly (upper right → upper left → lower left → lower right).

Comparing Records Over Time

Use the **Compare** dropdown in the toolbar to overlay a previous exam's data as ghost bars on the SVG chart.

1. Open the probing chart for the patient.
2. Use **Load** to load the most recent exam record.
3. Use **Compare** to select an earlier record as the baseline.
4. The SVG chart now shows ghost gray bars (previous) behind the coloured bars (current).
5. The **comparison strip** at the bottom shows: *X sites improved, Y worsened, Z unchanged* with a per-tooth breakdown.

📸 screenshots/perio-comparison.png Perio chart with ghost bars and comparison delta strip at bottom

Comparison view — ghost bars show the previous record; the strip at the bottom shows per-site deltas

Summary Statistics Bar

The bar at the very bottom of the probing chart dialog shows live statistics for the current record:

Statistic	Description
Sites	Number of sites recorded out of 192 total
Mean PD	Average pocket depth across all recorded sites
PD ≥ 4	Count and percentage of sites with PD 4 mm or more
PD ≥ 6	Count and percentage of sites with PD 6 mm or more
BOP	Percentage of recorded sites with bleeding on probing
Teeth	Number of teeth with at least one recorded site

CHAPTER 8 Documents & Attachments

The Documents section stores any file type associated with a patient — X-rays, photographs, referral letters, consent forms, lab reports, and more. Files are stored inside the vault folder in a structured directory.

📸 screenshots/documents.png Documents grid showing thumbnails, category pills, and file names

Documents grid — thumbnails for images, file icons for other types, category filter pills at top

Adding Documents

1. In the Documents section, click **Add Document** or drag files directly into the grid.
2. Select a **category** for the document (e.g. X-ray, Referral, Photo).
3. Optionally add a title and date.
4. The file is copied into the vault and a thumbnail is generated for images.

Viewing Documents

Click any document thumbnail to open a full-screen viewer. Images are displayed inline; other file types are opened in your system's default application.

Document Categories

Categories are fully configurable in **Settings** → **Document Categories**. The filter pills at the top of the Documents grid update automatically when you add or rename categories.

> **VAULT FOLDER STRUCTURE**
>
> Documents are stored at `vault/patients/[patient-id]/documents/[category]/filename`. You can open the vault folder in Finder/Explorer to access files directly.

CHAPTER 9 Dashboard & Analytics

The Dashboard provides a practice-wide overview of clinical outcomes. All statistics are computed from the structured data in your timeline entries — this is why accurate category and outcome tagging matters.

📸 screenshots/dashboard.png Dashboard showing stat cards, category bar chart, and outcome table

Practice dashboard — summary cards, category bar chart, and outcome breakdown table

Summary Cards

The top row shows key practice metrics at a glance: total patients, entries this month, overall success rate, and active treatment plans.

Category Bar Chart

Shows the volume of entries per treatment category over the selected time period. Click any bar to drill down into the individual entries for that category.

Outcome Table

A matrix of treatment categories (rows) vs. outcomes (columns). Each cell shows a count. Click any cell to see the individual entries matching that category+outcome combination.

📸 screenshots/dashboard-drilldown.png Drill-down entry list after clicking a cell in the outcome table

Drill-down view — click any cell in the outcome table to see matching entries

Filtering the Dashboard

Use the filter bar at the top of the Dashboard to restrict statistics to a date range or a specific doctor. This allows per-provider outcome analysis.

EXAMPLE ANALYSES

- Filter by *Endodontics* + date range → see your root canal success rate over time
- Filter by doctor name → compare outcomes between providers
- Click *Failed* → *Extracted* in the Prosthodontics row → see which crowned teeth were eventually lost

CHAPTER 10 Reports & CSV Export

The Reports page gives you a filterable flat table of all timeline entries across all patients. Use it to generate practice activity reports, audit exports, or referral letters.

📸 `screenshots/reports.png Reports page with filter bar and entry table below`

Reports page — filter bar (top), entry table (bottom), CSV export button (top right)

Available Filters

Filter	Description
Date range	Show entries between two dates
Categories	One or more treatment categories
Outcomes	One or more outcome types
Doctor	Entries attributed to a specific provider
Tooth numbers	Entries involving specific FDI tooth numbers

Exporting to CSV

1. Apply filters to narrow the entries as needed.
2. Click **Export CSV** at the top right.
3. A `.csv` file is saved to your Downloads folder. It can be opened in Excel, Numbers, or any spreadsheet application.

The CSV includes: patient name, date, category, outcome, tooth numbers, doctor, and the entry text.

> **USE CASE: INSURANCE REPORTING**
> Filter by date range + category (e.g. Endodontics), then export to CSV to prepare treatment summaries for insurance submissions.

CHAPTER 11 Settings

Settings is where you customise DentVault for your practice. Everything that has a "type", "category", or "label" can be renamed, extended, or removed here. Changes take effect immediately across the whole app.

📸 `screenshots/settings-overview.png Settings page with sections listed in sidebar`

Settings page — all configurable systems are accessible from the left column

Document Categories

The categories available when attaching a document (e.g. X-ray, Referral, Consent Form). Changes here automatically update the category filter pills in the Documents section and the vault folder structure.

Clinical Tags

Two separate tag lists:

- **Acute Problem Tags** — used in the Acute Problems box on the patient profile (e.g. Pain, Swelling, Abscess)
- **Medical History Tags** — used in the Medical History box (e.g. Diabetes, Hypertension, Anticoagulants)

Staff Roles

The role labels that appear next to staff names throughout the app (e.g. Principal Dentist, Associate, Hygienist, Oral Surgeon). Rename or add roles to match your practice structure.

Text Blocks

Reusable text snippets inserted with the `/` command palette in any entry text field. Add standard templates for post-operative instructions, recall reminders, referral language, and more.

📸 `screenshots/settings-text-blocks.png Text blocks list with name, trigger keyword, and preview text`

Text blocks — each block has a trigger keyword (typed after `/`) and an expandable body

Complication Types

The structured complication types that can be logged against a timeline entry (e.g. Post-operative Pain, Instrument Separation, Allergic Reaction). 13 defaults are provided. You can rename, add, or delete types.

Dental Tag Shortcuts

Accessible via **Edit Tags** in the dental chart toolbar. Each tag has a configurable single-letter keyboard shortcut for use during charting mode. Duplicate shortcuts are blocked on save.

📸 `screenshots/settings-edit-tags.png Edit Tags dialog showing tag colours, patterns, and keyboard shortcut inputs`

Edit Tags dialog — customise colours, fill patterns, and keyboard shortcuts for each dental condition

CHAPTER 12 Keyboard Shortcuts Reference

Global

`/`	Focus patient search
`Esc`	Close dialog / deselect

Timeline Entry

`Ctrl` + `Enter`	Save entry
`/` + keyword	Insert text block
`@` + name	Mention / tag colleague

Dental Chart — Navigation

`Enter`	Next tooth (charting mode)
`Shift` + `Enter`	Previous tooth
`Esc`	Exit charting / deselect tooth

Dental Chart — Tag Shortcuts

`g`	Gesund (Healthy)
`k`	Karies (Caries)
`f`	Füllung (Filling)
`o`	Krone (Crown)
`w`	Wurzelbehandlung (RCT)
`i`	Implantat (Implant)
`b`	Brücke (Bridge)
`x`	Fehlend (Missing)
`e`	Extrahiert (Extracted)
`p`	Impaktiert (Impacted)
`r`	Fraktur (Fracture)

Periodontal Chart — Navigation

`Tab`	Next PD input site (MB→B→DB→ML→L→DL)
`Enter`	Advance to next tooth
`Shift` + `Enter`	Go back to previous tooth
`↑` / `↓`	Increment / decrement PD value by 1 mm
`Esc`	Deselect tooth / exit charting

Dental Chart — Surface Grid

Click surface	Select / toggle surface
Drag across	Multi-select surfaces
Letter key	Apply tag to selected surfaces (or whole tooth)

FDI Charting Order

Both the dental chart and perio chart advance through teeth in this sequence:

Quadrant	FDI Numbers	Universal Numbers
Q1 — Upper Right	18, 17, 16, 15, 14, 13, 12, 11	1 → 8
Q2 — Upper Left	21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28	9 → 16
Q3 — Lower Left	38, 37, 36, 35, 34, 33, 32, 31	17 → 24

Q4 — Lower Right	41, 42, 43, 44, 45, 46, 47, 48	25 → 32